

BRAND AUDIT & CREATIVE MARKETING PROPOSAL: CASTEL MIMI

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Context: Strategic Portfolio Piece & Experiential Marketing Analysis

Date: 2025

Founded in 1893 by Constantin Mimi, last governor of Bessarabia. Located in Bulboaca. Preserves over a century of winemaking tradition and historical significance. Architecture reflects multiple eras: Tsarist Russia, Romanian, Soviet, and independent Moldova. Constantin Mimi saved the Bessarabian wine industry in 1904 by persuading the Tsar to protect vineyards. Recognized among the world's top 15 most beautiful wine-related architectural masterpieces.

Communiation Mix

Website and Social Media. They have an active online presence, but not maximized.

Advertising and PR. Strong media and influencer collaborations, limited international digital advertising.

Events and Interactive Experiences. Well-organized events that strengthen brand prestige (e.g., VinOpera, Noaptea Sânzâienelor).

Target audience

Wine enthusiasts and professionals. Families, corporate groups, and event organizers. Young audiences looking for unique travel and social media-worthy experiences.

What works well:

- Strong Brand Presence. Recognized in cultural tourism and the wine industry, both locally and internationally.
- Successful Events and Effective Promotion. Unique events attract a diverse audience, with strong social media engagement.

Castel Mimi has a series of unique events that are held every year, such as VinOpera, Sânziennele Night, Rose day, etc.

- Strategic Media Collaborations. Local and international media features reinforce the brand's premium image.

In 2022, Castel Mimi, through its brand AnimAliens Wines, collaborated with Carla's Dreams to launch a special edition of wines, a local singer, good known in Moldova and Romania.)

- Authentic Experiences and Strong Storytelling. The castle's history, wine traditions, and guided tours create a memorable emotional connection with visitors.

Areas for improvements:

Expanded Digital Advertising Strategies

- Create a TikTok account to promote the winery.
- Create engaging video campaigns for YouTube, TikTok, and Instagram Reels.

TikTok Challenge: #TripAtCastelMimi – A Trip to Castel Mimi

Concept & Message:

This challenge invites TikTok users to document a real trip to Castel Mimi in Moldova, sharing their experience from the journey to exploring the castle and its surroundings. It promotes local traditions, culture, and encourages others to visit the historic site. The goal is to make Castel Mimi a well-known destination for both locals and tourists.

Why It Can Go Viral:

- **Authenticity:** The challenge is based on real experiences, making it relatable and genuine for a broad audience.
- **Local Tourism:** It brings attention to Castel Mimi, encouraging more people to visit and explore Moldova's rich cultural heritage.
- **Global Reach:** Sharing on TikTok gives Castel Mimi international visibility, attracting tourists to Moldova.

#WineFilterChallenge – What's Your Perfect Wine?

Concept & Message:

The #WineFilterChallenge is an interactive TikTok test that matches different types of wine to a person's personality, similar to zodiac or MBTI tests. The user applies a filter that cycles through wines like Cabernet Sauvignon, Chardonnay, Rose, etc., to reveal which wine suits them best.

The message conveyed is that wine can reflect personality traits, and participants react excitedly or sarcastically depending on the result. The challenge can turn into a social game, encouraging users to share their results with friends and compare wine types.

It has the potential to go viral due to interactive filters, personality comparisons, and the possibility for wine brands to create custom filters to increase awareness.

Why It Can Go Viral:

- **Interactive Filters:** People love using filters that are easy to engage with and generate fun results, leading to higher interaction and sharing.
- **Personality Content:** TikTok users enjoy content based on personality tests and comparisons, making this challenge appealing to a broad audience.
- **Trend Integration:** It can be combined with popular trends like "What X are you?" or "POV: You've turned into a wine," making it more likely to catch on.

Diversification of Events

- Integrate artisan fairs and interactive workshops.
- Offer personalized experiences for corporate groups and team-building activities.

For events like Sânzianele Nights or Rose Day, incorporating an engaging treasure hunt could create a fun, interactive experience for attendees. Here's how it could unfold:

- **Treasure Hunt Setup:** Throughout the event, participants would follow a series of clues hidden around the celebration area. Each clue could lead them closer to the grand prize. For example, the clues could be hidden near specific activities, wine stations, or iconic locations related to the event.
- **QR Code Integration:** To make it more tech-savvy, each clue could be hidden behind QR codes. When participants scan the code with their phones, they would receive the next clue or a challenge that they need to complete at that spot (e.g., answering a wine-related trivia question or performing a quick task related to the theme of the event).
- **Challenges at Locations:** At various checkpoints, participants might need to complete fun activities—like tasting a wine and guessing its type, or sharing a quick story about their best wine experience. Once they finish the challenge, they would be rewarded with the next QR code and continue their journey.
- **Grand Prize:** The final destination of the treasure hunt could be a secret location, like a private area within the winery, where the winner receives the grand prize. This could be something special like a dinner with the winery's family or an exclusive wine tasting experience. The sense of achievement from finding the prize would leave participants with a memorable experience.
- **Social Engagement:** To make it more interactive and encourage social sharing, participants could be prompted to share their progress on social media. For example, they could take a photo at each checkpoint and post it with a hashtag like #SanzianeleTreasureHunt. This not only boosts engagement but also generates organic marketing for future events.

Influencer & Blogger Collaborations

- Partner with travel, gastronomy, and lifestyle influencers to expand international reach. *(They have an collaboration with „Best Dinner ever with love from our garden by Canada's most famous food blogger @laurent.dagenais and famous @renaud.blanchet at the Castel Mimi.” vut as far of what i found is only this, on their page)*

1. The Wine Wankers (@thewinewankers) – Fun & Educational Wine Reviews

"Blind Tasting Challenge" – A fun blind wine tasting where they guess the wine varieties and react humorously.

"Wine Myths Busted" – Short clips debunking common wine myths using Castel Mimi wines.

"The Perfect Pairing" – Testing which foods pair best with specific Castel Mimi wines in an exaggerated and entertaining way.

3. Eric Asimov (@ericasimov) – Expert Wine Reviews & Cultural Insights

"The Art of Tasting" – A professional wine tasting session explaining flavors, aromas, and textures.

"Wine & Culture" – Discussing the tradition of winemaking in Moldova and Castel Mimi's historical significance.

"Master Sommelier's Review" – A sophisticated review of a Castel Mimi wine, analyzing its body, aroma, and terroir.